

Health Cover Comparison

SUNIL THITE FAMILY · STAR HEALTH – SUPER STAR PREFERRED

Sunil Thite 17 Aug 1969 57 years Eldest life — sets the floater premium for all three	Anupama Thite 18 Sep 1973 53 years Enters the 56–60 band in Sep 2029	Ved Thite 7 Nov 2009 16 years Turns 17 on 7 Nov 2026 — child rates apply today
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Basis – premiums quoted 5 October 2026. Please confirm with us that the quotation was run on these three lives before acting on it.

RECOMMENDATION

Take the **₹20 lakh cover**. It costs only **₹12,719 a year more** than ₹10 lakh — 27.8% more premium for twice the protection, and with Sunil at 57 the thinner cover is the one more likely to run out. **Pay annually** unless the money would otherwise sit idle; the three-year discount is smaller than what the same cash earns in a fixed deposit.

The four options

OPTION	PREMIUM	COST PER YEAR	3 × ANNUAL	YOU SAVE	PER ₹1 LAKH	VERDICT
₹10 lakh — 1 year annual renewal	₹45,823	₹45,823	—	—	₹4,582	Cover too thin
₹10 lakh — 3 years paid up front	₹1,31,460	₹43,820	₹1,37,469	₹6,009	₹4,382	Weak discount
₹20 lakh — 1 year annual renewal	₹58,542	₹58,542	—	—	₹2,927	Recommended
₹20 lakh — 3 years paid up front	₹1,64,746	₹54,915	₹1,75,626	₹10,880	₹2,746	Fair alternative

Why ₹20 lakh, not ₹10 lakh

36% cheaper per rupee of cover — ₹2,927 per lakh against ₹4,582

In health insurance the first rupee of cover is always the most expensive. Doubling the sum insured adds **₹12,719 a year, or 27.8%** — not another 100%. That is ₹1,060 a month for a second ₹10 lakh.

A single cardiac or oncology admission in a Pune or Mumbai private hospital can run past ₹10 lakh on its own. With Sunil at 57, this is the decade in which that stops being hypothetical.

Is the three-year lock worth it?

Paying three years up front costs you the use of the year-two and year-three money. The break-even is the return at which paying annually comes out ahead.

COVER	SAVING	BREAK-EVEN	VERDICT
₹10 lakh	₹6,009	4.64%	Poor
₹20 lakh	₹10,880	6.76%	Fair

A fixed deposit comfortably beats 4.64%, so on ₹10 lakh the three-year discount is worth **less than leaving the money in the bank**. At ₹20 lakh it is close to FD rates — roughly a wash, worth taking if the cash would sit idle or you want the premium fixed through Sunil's late fifties.

One figure to confirm before you decide.

The savings above are the arithmetic difference between the two premiums quoted for the same cover — ₹1,37,469 less ₹1,31,460 is ₹6,009 at ₹10 lakh, and ₹1,75,626 less ₹1,64,746 is ₹10,880 at ₹20 lakh. If a larger savings figure has been quoted elsewhere, ask which base premium it is measured against, since it will not be the annual premium shown in the same quote.

Dates that move the premium

WHEN	WHO	WHAT CHANGES
7 Nov 2026	Ved	Turns 17. If any quote is age-banded on him, lock it before this date.
Sep 2029	Anupama	Moves from the 51–55 band into 56–60. A step up in her own rate, though the floater is still priced on Sunil.
Aug 2030	Sunil	Enters the 61–65 band. Usually the steepest single step in the age table, and it lifts the whole floater because he is the eldest life.
Nov 2034	Ved	Turns 25 and ages out of dependent cover on a family floater. He will need his own policy, starting fresh waiting periods at that point unless one is already running.

The structure worth pricing

A family floater is rated on the **eldest life**. Anupama at 53 and Ved at 16 are both being charged at a 57-year-old's rate. That is how floaters work, and for two adults close in age it is usually still the cheaper structure.

Ved is the exception. At 16 an individual policy for him costs a fraction of an adult premium. It is worth asking Star Health to quote **Sunil and Anupama on a floater, with Ved on his own policy**, against all three together.

Beyond price, a separate policy starts **Ved's own waiting periods and no-claim bonus** now, on a policy he keeps for life — rather than having them begin at 25 when he leaves the family floater.

Why the timing matters at 57

Pre-existing conditions carry a waiting period of up to three years. Starting that clock now means it is **fully served before Sunil turns 60** — ahead of the years in which a claim becomes materially more likely.

Every year of delay pushes the end of that waiting period deeper into the decade where it is most likely to be needed, and does so at a higher entry age.

This is the one part of the decision that cannot be recovered later. The sum insured can be raised at renewal; a waiting period can only start when the policy does.

What to ask Star Health for next. Three quotes that would settle the structure: Sunil and Anupama as a two-member floater at ₹20 lakh; Ved as an individual policy at ₹10 lakh; and all three together at ₹20 lakh, which is what is quoted overleaf. Comparing the first two added together against the third decides whether splitting is worth it.

Before you buy

- **Declare existing conditions in full, for all three.** Nothing else on these two pages matters if a claim is later rejected for non-disclosure. If Sunil or Anupama has any condition under treatment, say so now and let it be loaded or excluded openly.
- **Check whether these premiums include GST.** A quote excluding it changes the comparison materially, and the tax treatment of health premiums has moved in recent years.
- **Confirm the waiting periods and room-rent terms** for pre-existing conditions and specific treatments, and whether the plan carries a room-rent or co-payment cap. These decide what you actually recover, far more than the premium difference does.
- **The three-year premium is not fully deductible in year one.** Under Section 80D a multi-year premium is allowed proportionately across the years it covers, so paying up front brings no tax advantage — and 80D applies only under the old tax regime.
- **A three-year lock cuts both ways.** It fixes the premium against mid-term rate revisions, which matters with Sunil approaching 60. It also prevents porting to a better or cheaper insurer for three years.
- **Count any employer group cover as temporary.** It ends with the job and cannot be ported on the same terms, so it should not reduce the sum insured you buy privately.

Ages stated as on 5 October 2026 and calculated from the dates of birth supplied. Age bands shown are the five-year bands in common use; the insurer's own bands and revision dates govern. Break-even returns are calculated by discounting three annual premiums to present value and comparing with the single three-year premium; they assume premiums remain unchanged on renewal, which is not guaranteed. Premiums, terms, waiting periods and tax treatment are as determined by the insurer and prevailing law, and are subject to change and to underwriting. Please read the policy wording and prospectus before purchasing.